

STAGE FIFTEEN • BUSINESS & ORGANIZATIONAL ACUMEN

FIRSTS

PARTICIPANT PRE-WORK

A short primer to send before each session, so people arrive oriented

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

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FIRSTS • Participant Pre-Work Handout

Stage Fifteen • Business & Organizational Acumen

FOR FACILITATORS

Send the relevant section below 2-3 days before each session. This stage's exercises are meaningfully more useful applied to a real organization than a hypothetical one — the most valuable pre-work is simply arriving with something specific in mind.

Before Session 1: Understanding How Organizations Work

WHAT TO DO BEFORE THIS SESSION

- Think of one organization you can reference throughout this session — a current job, internship, or a company you know reasonably well from the outside.
- No devices or logins required for this session; it's primarily reflection and conversation.

WHY THIS MATTERS

This entire stage is noticeably more useful applied to a real organization than worked purely hypothetically. Having one in mind before the session starts means less time spent deciding what to analyze.

Before Session 2: Analyzing the Business

WHAT TO DO BEFORE THIS SESSION

- Identify one real business problem, initiative, or decision at your organization you could analyze throughout this session.
- Bring a laptop; several exercises this session involve real research (market, competitive, industry).

WHY THIS MATTERS

This is the most analysis-heavy session in the stage. A real, current problem to work with makes the business case and cost-benefit exercises genuinely useful rather than abstract.

Before Session 3: Strategic & Reflective Business Thinking

WHAT TO DO BEFORE THIS SESSION

- Bring to mind one process inefficiency you've noticed at your organization, for use in FIRST S23.
- This is the final session of the stage; come ready to reflect back across all three sessions, not just this one.

WHY THIS MATTERS

FIRST S23 asks for a real, specific inefficiency, not a hypothetical one — arriving with one in mind saves real session time.